

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Natural gas leak

HOME BUILDING / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

If you smell gas or suspect a leak, leave the area on foot immediately. Do not use switches, flames, phones or engines in the suspected leak area. Once safely away, call emergency services and your gas utility. Do not reenter until cleared.

Do now.

- ☐ **Leave now**
01 Do not search for the leak or stop to collect belongings.
- ☐ **Avoid ignition**
02 Do not turn electrical devices on or off, light flames, operate garage doors or start a vehicle nearby.
- ☐ **Call from safety**
03 Give the address and what you noticed to emergency services and the utility.
- ☐ **Keep others clear**
04 Wait outside the danger area and follow responder instructions.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Stay outside and away even if the utility line is busy. Keep others from entering without approaching the leak. A lack of response does not make reentry safe; use another place to stay until the hazard has been assessed by qualified personnel.

Watch for.

Never use a flame to test for leaks or attempt your own repair.

People & practical needs.

Use a short instruction everyone can follow: leave together by the nearest safe route. Include people who cannot smell well, hear an alarm or move independently. Keep the meeting point away from the suspected gas area.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Have the utility or a qualified technician restore service and inspect appliances when required.

Check the next usable option

Have the utility or a qualified technician restore service and inspect appliances when required.

When the first option is unavailable

Stay outside and away even if the utility line is busy. Keep others from entering without approaching the leak. A lack of response does not make reentry safe; use another place to stay until the hazard has been assessed by qualified personnel.

Questions in the field.

Should I search for the source?

Leave first. Do not operate switches, phones, plugs or appliances in the suspected area and do not try to find the leak with a flame. Make the call from a safe distance after leaving.

What if someone is still inside?

Tell the emergency responder who may be inside and the last known location. Do not reenter to search or retrieve a pet. Reentry requires the appropriate qualified clearance; disappearance of the smell is not proof of safety.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

Natural gas leak · official guidance

<https://www.phmsa.dot.gov/safety-awareness/pipeline/pipeline-leak-recognition-and-what-do>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/gas-leak/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.